

Keeping your clinic's WhatsApp number safe

A guide for reception and clinic staff who send booking messages from ClinVision.

The one thing to remember: WhatsApp blocks numbers that look like spam. Send personal messages, one patient at a time, only about that patient's own visit. Never send offers, or the same message to a list of people.

1. Why this matters

ClinVision opens WhatsApp with the message already written, and you press Send. The message goes from your clinic's own WhatsApp number. If WhatsApp decides that number is sending spam, it can stop it from starting new chats, or ban it for good. A ban cannot be undone on request, and the clinic loses its chats with patients. Following the rules below keeps that risk low.

2. What WhatsApp treats as spam

- The same message sent to many people.
- Messages to people who have not saved your number or have not agreed to hear from you.
- A sudden burst of many messages in a short time.
- Automatic sending: browser extensions, auto-sender tools, or modified WhatsApp apps.
- **People blocking or reporting your number.** This is the strongest signal of all. Most of the rules below exist to stop it.

3. Set up the clinic's number properly

- ☐ Use the free **WhatsApp Business** app on a number used **only for the clinic**. Never use a doctor's or staff member's personal number.
- ☐ Fill in the business profile: clinic name, address, opening hours.
- ☐ Switch on two-step verification, and keep the app updated.
- ☐ Never install modified apps (such as GB WhatsApp), browser extensions, or auto-sender tools.

4. When the patient books

Tell the patient out loud, every time, so the first message is expected and not a surprise:

*"You will get a WhatsApp from this number with your token and a link. Please save it as **[Clinic name]**, or just reply Hi."*

- Read the phone number back to the patient. A wrong number means a stranger gets the message, and strangers report.
- If the patient does not want WhatsApp, do not send. Offer a phone call instead.

5. What to send and what never to send

Send

- Booking confirmation
- Token number and queue link
- "Please come to reception"
- Answers to a patient's own question
- One message for each event

Never send

- Offers, discounts, health camps
- Festival greetings or health tips to a list
- The same message to many patients
- Forwarded or viral health messages
- Anything the patient did not ask for

6. How to send

- **One patient at a time**, when the booking happens. Never in batches, and never send to many patients in a row.
- Read the message before pressing Send. You can edit the words, and a personal touch is good.
- If ClinVision asks "Slow down on WhatsApp?", it means you opened 5 or more messages in a minute. Stop and wait.
- Do not add patients to WhatsApp groups. Do not use broadcast lists for patients.

7. Replies: YES and NO

Appointment messages end by asking the patient to reply YES or NO. A patient who replies is no longer a stranger to WhatsApp, so replies help protect the number. ClinVision does not read or act on replies, and nothing changes in the app whatever the patient answers. Reception can read the replies in WhatsApp and decide what to do.

Patient replies	What reception can do
YES	Nothing more is needed. A short "Thank you, see you soon" is a good reply.
NO	The patient may not come. Reception decides: call to reschedule, or leave the booking as it is. Any change to the booking is made by hand in ClinVision. A short "Noted, thank you" is a good reply.
No reply	Do not send the message again and again. If it matters, call the patient.

8. Stop requests, blocks and wrong numbers

- If a patient asks you to stop, in any words, or you see they blocked the number, **never message them again**. Use phone calls, and note it on their record.
- If someone replies "wrong number" or "who is this?", apologise once, correct the number in ClinVision, and do not message it again.

9. Warning signs, and what to do

- WhatsApp shows a message that the account is **restricted**. A restricted number can still reply to existing chats, but cannot start new ones.

- Many messages stay on one grey tick, or several people reply "who is this?".

If this happens:

- Stop all sending from that number at once. Phone the patients who need to hear from you.
- Tap "Request a review" in the app if it is offered. Do not keep trying.
- Do not switch to another number, install mods, or use tools to get around it. That makes it worse.
- Tell the clinic owner straight away. Keep the clinic's phone number printed on receipts so patients can always call.

10. Protect patient privacy

- A patient's phone number is personal data under India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023. Use it only for the patient's care.
- Never upload patient numbers to a marketing or bulk-message tool, and never share them with anyone outside the clinic.

11. Reception's daily checklist

- ☐ Told each patient to save the number or reply, and read their number back.
- ☐ Sent messages one by one, only about the visit.
- ☐ Checked WhatsApp for replies and "wrong number" messages, and acted on them.
- ☐ No message sent to anyone who asked to stop or blocked the number.
- ☐ No offers, greetings or group messages sent.

This guide follows WhatsApp's published terms and common good practice. WhatsApp does not publish exact daily limits and can change its rules at any time, so no guide can promise that a number will never be restricted. Following these rules makes it much less likely. ClinVision helps by sending nothing automatically: every message is written for the patient and sent by a person pressing Send.